

Earthy = Marsy

Earthy = Venusy

But, for reasons we have already discussed — namely, the fact that identity is transitive — these three claims do not sit well together. So it appears that the psychological theory implies a contradiction.

Marsy $\neq$ Venusy



Basically the same point could be made about the version of the story on which, after the transmission to Mars, the individual who steps into the teletransporter on Earth steps back out. To tell that version of the story, we'd just need to introduce two names — Earthy-1 and Earthy-2 — for the individual on earth pre-teletransportation, and the individual who exists after the teletransportation.

It is easy enough to turn this into an argument against the psychological theory of survival.

1. If the psychological theory of survival is true, then Earthy = Marsy.
 2. If the psychological theory of survival is true, then Earthy = Venusy.
 3. If the psychological theory of survival is true, then Marsy = Venusy. (1,2)
 4. Marsy $\neq$ Venusy.
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C. The psychological theory of survival is false.
(3,4)

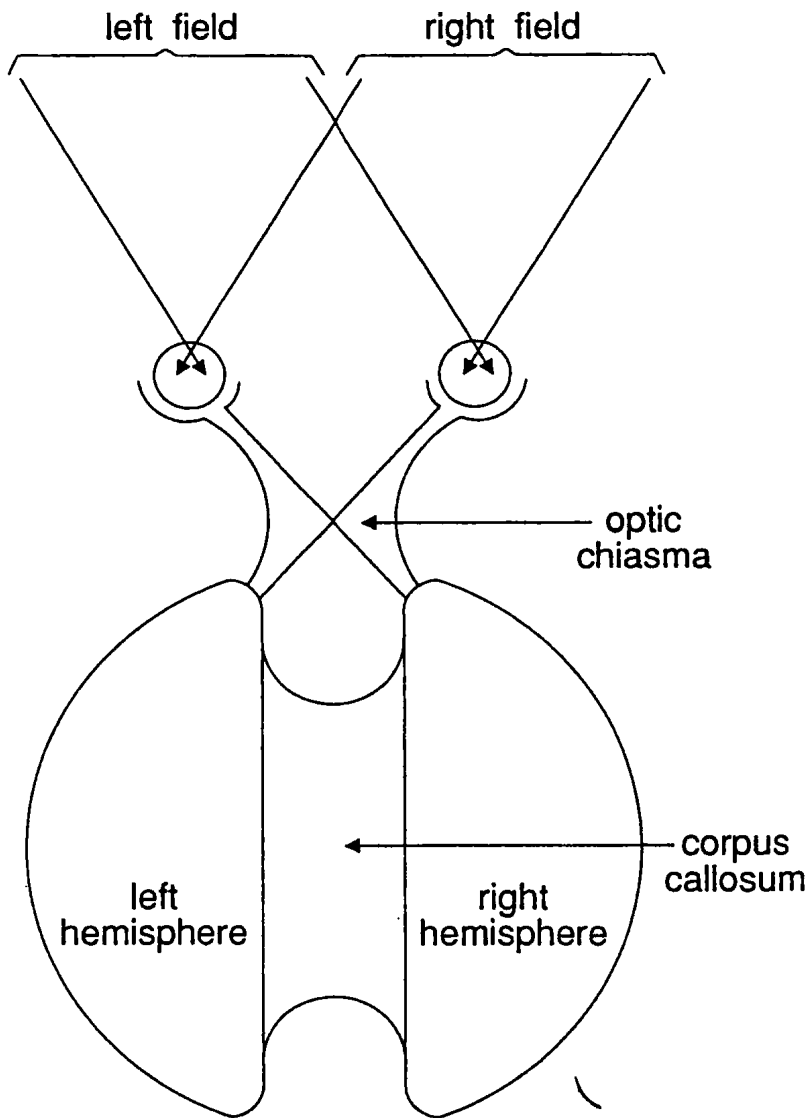
We now have three ‘pure’ views of personal identity on the table, along with the various combinations of those views.

THE TELETRANSPORTATION ARGUMENT

The first puzzle involves real-world cases involving 'split brain' subjects.

Our topic today is a cluster of puzzles about identity and survival. These puzzles put pressure, in different ways, on some of true assumptions about survival we have been making so far.

One good way to test out your preferred view of survival is to think about what your view implies with respect to these three puzzles.



These are patients whose corpus callosum has been severed. The corpus callosum is a pathway which connects the left and right hemispheres of the human brain and, in normal subjects, allows the two hemispheres of the brain to exchange information.

If the corpus callosum is severed, the two hemispheres of the brain cannot exchange information. So any sensory data about the environment available to, for example, the left hemisphere, will not be available to guide the movements of the left hand, which is controlled by the right hemisphere. Information available only to the right hemisphere will not be reportable in speech, since speech is controlled by the left hemisphere.

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